



- 3 Follow the application method for the color you will be using to apply the color mixture.
- 4 Check the development at 5-minute intervals until the desired color has been achieved. Note the timing on the service record card.



- 5 When satisfactory color has developed, remove the protective foil or plastic wrap. Place a towel under the strand, mist it thoroughly with water, add shampoo, and massage through. Rinse by spraying with water. Dry the hair strand with the towel and observe the results.
- 6 Adjust the timing, haircolor formulation, or application method as necessary and proceed with the color service.

CLEAN-UP AND DISINFECTION

- ☐ Discard disposable items.
- ☐ Clean and disinfect the chair and workstation.
- ☐ Dispose of single-use items. Place all used linens, towels, and capes in the laundry.
- ☐ Store products, materials, and service record card.
- ☐ Wash your hands.

TEMPORARY COLOR RINSE

MATERIALS, IMPLEMENTS, AND EQUIPMENT

- ☐ Applicator bottle
- ☐ Comb
- ☐ Protective gloves
- ☐ Service record card
- ☐ Shampoo
- ☐ Shampoo cape
- ☐ Temporary haircolor product
- ☐ Timer
- ☐ Towels



CAUTION

If the client is to receive a haircut, perform the cut before applying a color rinse.

PREPARATION

- 1 Assemble all necessary supplies.
- 2 Prepare the client and drape with towels and waterproof cape.
- 3 Examine the client's scalp and hair.
- 4 Select the desired shade of color rinse.
- 5 Perform a strand test.

PROCEDURE



- 1 Drape the client for a haircoloring service. Slide a towel down from the back of the client's head and place lengthwise across the client's shoulders. Cross the ends of the towel beneath the chin and place the cape over the towel. Fasten the cape in the back. Fold the towel over the top of the cape and secure in front.
- 2 Shampoo and towel-dry the hair.
- 3 Make sure the client is comfortably reclined at the shampoo bowl.
- 4 Put on gloves.



- 5 Put the color into the applicator bottle and apply as directed by the manufacturer's instructions.
- 6 Apply the color and work around the entire head.



- 7 Blend the color with your gloved hands or comb it through the hair, applying more color as necessary.
- 8 Do not rinse the hair. Towel-blot excess product.
- 9 Proceed with styling and finish.

CLEAN-UP AND DISINFECTION

- ☐ Wash and disinfect tools and implements.
- ☐ Clean and disinfect the work area.
- ☐ Sweep up hair and deposit in closed receptacle.
- ☐ Dispose of single-use items. Place all used linens, towels, and capes in the laundry.
- ☐ Wash your hands.
- ☐ Record the results on the service record card.

DEMIPERMANENT COLOR APPLICATION

MATERIALS, IMPLEMENTS, AND EQUIPMENT

- ☐ Chemical cape
- ☐ Color brushes
- ☐ Color chart
- ☐ Comb
- ☐ Conditioner
- ☐ Cotton
- ☐ Glass or plastic bowl
- ☐ Plastic cap (optional)
- ☐ Plastic clips
- ☐ Protective cream
- ☐ Protective gloves
- ☐ Selected color
- ☐ Service record card
- ☐ Shampoo
- ☐ Timer
- ☐ Towels

PREPARATION

- 1 Perform a preliminary patch test with any haircolor product containing aniline derivative 24 to 48 hours before the service. Proceed only if the test is negative.
- 2 Perform client consultation, select a haircolor product, and record results on client record card.
- 3 Drape client and apply protective cream.
- 4 Perform a strand test and record the results.

PROCEDURE

- 1 Shampoo the client's hair with mild shampoo, and towel-dry.
- 2 Put on gloves.



- 3 Part the hair into four sections—from ear to ear and from front center of forehead to center nape—and apply protective cream around the hairline and over the ears.
- 4 Outline the partings with color product.



5 Take ¼- to ½-inch partings, and apply the color to the new growth or scalp area in all four sections. Take horizontal subsections, starting in the nape of a rear quadrant, repeat on other rear quadrant. When you reach the front, you will take vertical sections applying product so the hair lays away from the face.



6 After all four sections are completed, work the color through the rest of the hair shaft to the ends until the hair is fully saturated.

- 7 Set timer to process. In addition to following the manufacturer's directions, check the haircolor every 5 minutes as it is processing to ensure you are not overdepositing color on porous hair. Some colors require the use of a plastic cap. To prevent the elastic of the plastic cap from leaving a mark on client's face, place cotton under cap elastic on face and hairline.
- 8 When processing is complete, massage color into a lather and rinse thoroughly with warm water.
- 9 Remove any stains from around the hairline with shampoo or stain remover.
- 10 Shampoo the hair. Condition as needed.

CLEAN-UP AND DISINFECTION

- ☐ Wash and disinfect tools and implements.
- ☐ Clean and disinfect the work area.
- ☐ Dispose of single-use items. Place all used linens, towels, and capes in the laundry.
- ☐ Wash your hands.
- ☐ Record the results on the service record card.

SINGLE-PROCESS PERMANENT COLOR APPLICATIONS: VIRGIN AND RETOUCH

MATERIALS, IMPLEMENTS, AND EQUIPMENT

- ☐ Applicator bottle or brush and bowl
- ☐ Color chart
- ☐ Comb
- ☐ Conditioner
- ☐ Cotton
- ☐ Hydrogen peroxide (developer)
- ☐ Measuring cup or beaker
- ☐ Plastic cap (optional, depending on the manufacturer's directions)
- ☐ Plastic clips (optional, depending on length of hair)
- ☐ Protective cream
- ☐ Protective gloves
- ☐ Service Record card
- ☐ Shampoo
- ☐ Shampoo cape
- ☐ Single-process permanent color product
- ☐ Timer
- ☐ Towels

PREPARATION

- 1 Perform a preliminary patch test with any hair-color product containing aniline derivative 24 to 48 hours before the service. Proceed only if the test is negative.
- 2 Perform client consultation, select haircolor product, and record results on client record card.
- 3 Drape client and apply protective cream.
- 4 Perform a strand test and record the results.

VIRGIN APPLICATION PROCEDURE

- 1 Follow the manufacturer's directions.



- 2 Put on gloves and part dry hair into four sections. Most permanent haircolors do not require shampooing before the application of color.
- 3 Prepare color formula for either bottle or brush application method.



4 Begin in the section where the hair is most resistant or where there will be the most color change, usually in the back of the head.



5 Part off ¼-inch subsections and apply color to the mid-shaft area. Stay at least ½ inch from the scalp and do not apply to the porous ends at this time.

6 Process according to the strand test results and the manufacturer's directions.



7 Check color development. When the hair is halfway to the desired color, apply remaining product to hair at the scalp, then pull the color through to the hair ends.

- 8 Lightly wet client's hair with warm water and lather. Massage lather through the hair.
- 9 Rinse thoroughly using lukewarm or tepid water, shampoo, and condition. Remove skin stains as necessary.
- 10 Rinse, towel-blot, and style.
- 11 Record results.

TINT RETOUCH PROCEDURE

To retouch new hair growth, use the same preparation steps as for coloring virgin hair. Then proceed as follows:

- 12 Refer to the client record card for correct color selection and other information.
- 13 Section the hair into four quadrants and apply the tint to dry hair, starting in the areas where hair is most resistant.
- 14 Apply the tint to the new growth using ¼-inch partings. Do not overlap onto previously tinted hair. Check frequently for color development.
- 15 When color has almost developed, dilute the remaining tint by adding a mild shampoo or warm water. Apply and gently work the mixture through the hair with the fingertips. Blend the color from the scalp through the hair ends for even distribution.
- 16 Process for the required time, following the manufacturer's directions.
- 17 Rinse with warm water to remove excess color.
- 18 Use an acid-balanced shampoo, condition, and rinse thoroughly. Remove skin stains, if necessary.
- 19 Style the hair as desired.

CLEAN-UP AND DISINFECTION

- ☐ Wash and disinfect tools and implements.
- ☐ Clean and disinfect the work area.
- ☐ Dispose of single-use items. Place all used linens, towels, and capes in the laundry.
- ☐ Wash your hands.
- ☐ Record the results on the service record card.

DOUBLE-PROCESS HAIRCOLORING

STEP 1: LIGHTENING VIRGIN HAIR

MATERIALS, IMPLEMENTS, AND EQUIPMENT

- | | | |
|--|---|--|
| ☐ Chemical cape | ☐ Glass or plastic mixing bowl | ☐ Protective gloves |
| ☐ Color brushes | ☐ Hydrogen peroxide developer | ☐ Service record card |
| ☐ Comb | ☐ Lightener | ☐ Shampoo |
| ☐ Conditioner | ☐ Plastic clips | ☐ Timer |
| ☐ Cotton | ☐ Protective cream | ☐ Towels |

PREPARATION

- 1 Perform a preliminary patch test with any haircolor product containing aniline derivative 24 to 48 hours before the service. Proceed only if the test is negative.
- 2 Perform client consultation, select haircoloring and lightening products, and record on client record card.
- 3 Drape client and apply protective cream.
- 4 Perform a strand test and record the results.

PROCEDURE FOR LIGHTENING VIRGIN HAIR

- 1 Section dry hair into four quadrants.
- 2 Apply protective cream around hairline. Put on gloves.
- 3 Prepare the lightening formula and use it immediately.



- 4 An option for a clean and comfortable application is to place cotton around and through all four sections to protect the scalp. Continue by placing strips of cotton at the scalp area along the partings for each subsection. This process will prevent the lightener from touching the base of the hair.



⑤ Part off ¼-inch subsection and apply the lightener ½ inch away from the scalp, working the lightener through the mid-strands and up to the porous ends.



⑥ Continue to apply the lightener. Double check the application, adding more lightener if necessary. Do not comb the lightener through the hair. The lightener will stop processing if it dries out. Keep the lightener moist during development by reapplying if the mixture dries on the hair.



⑦ Check for lightening action about 15 minutes before the time indicated by the preliminary strand test. Spray a hair strand with a water bottle and remove the lightener with a damp towel. Examine the strand. If the strand is not light enough, reapply the mixture and continue testing frequently until the desired level is reached.



8 Remove the cotton from the scalp area. Apply the lightener to the hair near the scalp with ½-inch partings.

9 Apply lightener to the porous ends and process until the entire hair strand has reached the desired stage.

10 Rinse the hair thoroughly with warm water. Shampoo gently and condition as needed, keeping your hands under the hair to avoid tangling.

11 Neutralize the alkalinity of the hair with an acidic conditioner. Recondition if necessary.

12 Towel-dry the hair, or dry it completely under a cool dryer if required by the manufacturer.

13 Examine the scalp for any abrasions. Analyze the condition of the hair.

14 Proceed with a toner application if desired. If no toner is needed, dry and style the hair.

CLEAN-UP AND DISINFECTION

- ☐ Wash and disinfect tools and implements.
- ☐ Clean and disinfect work area.
- ☐ Dispose of single-use items. Place all used linens, towels, and capes in the laundry.
- ☐ Wash your hands.
- ☐ Record the results on the service record card.

STEP 2: TONER APPLICATION

MATERIALS, IMPLEMENTS, AND EQUIPMENT

- ☐ Applicator bottle
- ☐ Bowl
- ☐ Chemical cape
- ☐ Conditioner
- ☐ Cotton
- ☐ Glass or plastic mixing bowl
- ☐ Hydrogen peroxide developer
- ☐ Plastic clips
- ☐ Protective cream
- ☐ Protective gloves
- ☐ Selected toner
- ☐ Service record card
- ☐ Shampoo
- ☐ Tail comb
- ☐ Timer
- ☐ Tint brush
- ☐ Towels

PREPARATION

- 1 Perform a preliminary patch test with any haircolor product containing aniline derivative 24 to 48 hours before the service. Proceed only if the test is negative.
- 2 Perform client consultation.
- 3 Drape client.
- 4 Pre-lighten the hair to the desired level.
- 5 Shampoo with cool or tepid water, rinse, condition, and towel-dry the hair.

PROCEDURE FOR TONER APPLICATION

- 1 Put on gloves.
- 2 Select the desired toner shade.
- 3 Apply protective cream around the hairline and over the ears.
- 4 Take a strand test and record the results on the client's service record card.
- 5 If using a toner with developer, mix the toner and the developer in a nonmetallic bowl or bottle, following the manufacturer's directions.

- 6 Part the hair into four equal sections, using the end of the tail comb or applicator brush. Avoid scratching the scalp.
- 7 Take a strand test. At the crown of one of the back sections, part off ¼-inch partings and apply the toner from the scalp up to, but not including, the porous ends. If it indicates proper color development, start application in the back at the nape and work application forward.
- 8 Gently work the toner through the ends of the hair, using an applicator brush or your fingers.
- 9 If necessary for coverage, apply additional toner to the hair and distribute evenly. Leave the hair loose or cover with a plastic cap if required.
- 10 Time the procedure according to your strand test. Check frequently until the desired color has been reached evenly throughout the entire hair shaft and ends.
- 11 Remove the toner by wetting the hair and massaging the toner into a lather.
- 12 Rinse with warm water, shampoo gently, and thoroughly rinse again.
- 13 Apply an acidic conditioner to close the cuticle, lower the pH, and help prevent fading.
- 14 Remove any stains from the skin, hairline, and neck.
- 15 Style as desired. Use caution to avoid stretching the hair.

CLEAN-UP AND DISINFECTION

- ☐ Wash and disinfect tools and implements.
- ☐ Clean and disinfect the work area.
- ☐ Dispose of single-use items. Place all used linens, towels, and capes in the laundry.
- ☐ Wash your hands.
- ☐ Record the results on the service record card.

SPECIAL EFFECTS

MATERIALS, IMPLEMENTS, AND EQUIPMENT

- ☐ Applicator bottle
- ☐ Chemical cape
- ☐ Color brushes
- ☐ Conditioner
- ☐ Foil
- ☐ Glass or plastic mixing bowl
- ☐ Gloves
- ☐ Lightener
- ☐ Plastic clips
- ☐ Service record card
- ☐ Shampoo
- ☐ Tail comb
- ☐ Timer
- ☐ Towels

PREPARATION FOIL TECHNIQUES

- 1 Perform a preliminary patch test 24 to 48 hours before the service with any product containing aniline derivative. Proceed only if the test is negative.
- 2 Perform client consultation and record on client record card.
- 3 Drape client.
- 4 Perform a strand test and record the results.

PROCEDURE FOR FOIL TECHNIQUE

- 1 Part hair into six sections. Start by dividing the hair into four quadrants, from front hairline to nape, and ear to ear. In the front, you will then subdivide your right and left quadrants into a top and side section at the parietal ridge above the ear.



- 2 Prepare the lightening formula, and use it immediately.



FOCUS ON

When performing the foil technique over the entire head, the sequence of application should be back, lower crown, sides, top, and front.



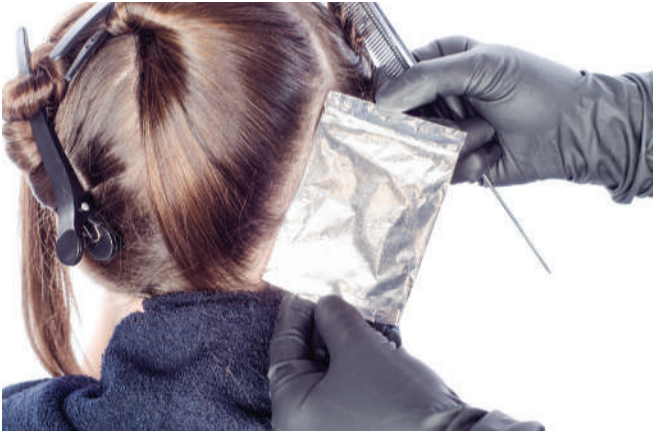
3 Starting in the right back section, with a tail comb, take a thin diagonal slice or weave out the strands, following the shape of the hairline. From this slice you will then take a fine weave of hair and place a piece of foil under it.



4 Holding the hair taut, brush lightener starting from 2 inches from the top of the foil to the ends, using only enough product to secure the foil in place. Work the product up to ¼ inch from the edge of the foil.



5 Fold the foil in half until the ends meet.



- 6 Fold the foil in half again, using the comb to crease it.



- 7 Take a ¼-inch subsection in between foils. Clip this hair up and out of the way. Note the contrast in size between the foiled and unfoiled subsections.

- 8 Continue working up the back right side of the head until the section is complete.

- 9 Repeat this procedure on the back left side of the head.



- 10 Work around the head to the left side.



11 Work up the side, bring fine slices of hair into the foil, and apply lightener to the hair.

12 Move to the other side of the head and complete the matching sections.



13 Move to the top right side of the head. Take a fine slice of hair, from the top of the side section to the center part, following the shape of the hairline. Place it on the foil, and apply lightener.



14 Continue toward the top until the last foil is placed. Repeat on the top left side of the head.

15 Allow the lightener to process according to the strand test.

16 Check the foils for the desired lightness.

17 Remove the foils one at a time at the shampoo area. Rinse the hair immediately to prevent the color from affecting the untreated hair.



18 A haircolor glaze is an optional service added onto a highlighting to add shine to the finished result. If desired, apply a haircolor glaze to the hair from the scalp to the ends. Skip to step 20 if you do not use a haircolor glaze.



19 Work the glaze into the hair to make sure it is completely saturated, and process per the manufacturer's directions.

20 Rinse the hair, shampoo, condition, and style the hair as desired.

CLEAN-UP AND DISINFECTION

- ☐ Wash and disinfect tools and implements.
- ☐ Clean and disinfect the work area.
- ☐ Dispose of single-use items. Place all used linens, towels, and capes in the laundry.
- ☐ Wash your hands.
- ☐ Record the results on the service record card.

COLORING MUSTACHES AND BEARDS

MATERIALS, IMPLEMENTS, AND EQUIPMENT

- Chemical cape
- Coloring solutions (nos. 1 and 2)
- Cotton-tipped applicators
- Petroleum jelly
- Soap
- Stain remover
- Towels



PROCEDURE



- 1 Seat the client in a comfortable position and drape for a chemical service.
- 2 Apply clean headrest cover.
- 3 Recline chair slightly about 45 degrees to access hair under the chin.



- 4 Place a clean towel across the chest and shoulders.



- 5 Cleanse the facial hair with warm, soapy water and pat dry with a cloth towel.



- 6 Apply petroleum jelly around the facial hairline.
- 7 Remove the cap on solution no. 1. Moisten a cotton-tipped applicator in the solution. Replace the cap on bottle no. 1.
- 8 Remove any excess solution by touching the tip of the applicator to a towel.



- 9 Apply the solution to the mustache and/or beard hair only and avoid touching the skin.
- 10 Set timer according to the manufacturer's direction.
- 11 Following the manufacturer's instructions, solution no. 1 may be reapplied two more times, using a new cotton-tipped applicator for each application.



- 12 Use a small square-tipped brush to apply solution no. 2, taking care to apply the solution from the hairline in the direction of hair growth.



- 13 Remove any stains with the manufacturer's stain remover. Do not rub.



- 14 Wash the mustache or beard gently with soap and cool water.
 15 Repeat the process if a deeper color is desired.
 16 Style the mustache and/or beard as desired.



CAUTION

Do not use an aniline derivative tint with facial coloring. Using this may cause serious irritation and damage.

CLEAN-UP AND DISINFECTION

- ☐ Wash and disinfect tools and implements.
- ☐ Clean and disinfect work area.
- ☐ Dispose of single-use items. Place all used linens, towels, and capes in the laundry.
- ☐ Wash your hands.
- ☐ Record the results on the service record card.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

- 1 Define haircoloring and lightening.
- 2 List the colors of the color wheel. Identify primary, secondary, and complementary colors.
- 3 List four types of haircoloring products.
- 4 Identify the types of non-oxidation and oxidation haircolors.
- 5 Explain the difference between semipermanent and demipermanent haircolor products.
- 6 List the one haircolor ingredient that requires a patch or predisposition test.
- 7 List the volumes of hydrogen peroxide used in haircoloring.
- 8 Explain how to test for sensitivities or allergies to haircolor products.
- 9 What is a strand test?
- 10 What professional products use a single-process application? Double-process application?
- 11 Explain the lightening process.
- 12 List the products used to color beards and mustaches.

CHAPTER GLOSSARY

activator (AK-tih-vay-ter)	p. 656	an oxidizer, consisting of powdered persulfate salts, that is added to haircolors, lighteners, or hydrogen peroxide to increase the chemical action of the product
aniline derivatives (AN-ul-un DUR-ive-it-ivez)	p. 650	uncolored dye precursors that combine with hydrogen peroxide to form larger, permanent color molecules in the cortex; the ingredient that requires a patch test
base color (BAYS KUL-ur)	p. 647	the predominant tone of an existing color
cap technique	p. 663	coloring or lightening technique that involves pulling strands of hair through a perforated cap with a plastic or metal hook
color fillers (KUL-ur FIL-urz)	p. 660	equalize porosity and deposit color in one application to provide a uniform contributing pigment on pre-lightened hair
complementary colors (kahm-pluh-MEN-tur-ee KUL-urz)	p. 645	a primary and secondary color positioned opposite each other on the color wheel
contributing pigment (kun-TRIB-yoot-ing PIG-ment)	p. 644	pigment that lies under the natural hair color that is exposed when the natural color is lightened
demipermanent haircolor (DEM-ih PUR-muh-nent HAYR-KUL-ur)	p. 651	deposit-only haircolor product similar to semipermanent but longer lasting
developer (dee-VEL-up-ur)	p. 654	also known as <i>oxidizing agents</i> or <i>catalysts</i> ; when mixed with an oxidation haircolor, supplies the necessary oxygen gas to develop color molecules and create a change in hair color
double-process haircoloring (DUB-ul PRAH-ses HAYR-KUL-ur-ing)	p. 663	a two-step combination of lightening and haircoloring
dye removers (DYE ree-MOOV-urz)	p. 660	products used to strip built-up color from the hair
fillers (FIL-urz)	p. 660	preparations designed to equalize porosity and/or deposit a base color in one application
foil technique (FOYL FRAWST)	p. 663	coloring or highlighting technique using foil to apply product to specific hair sections
free-form technique (FREE-form tek-NEEK)	p. 663	also known as <i>balyage</i> or <i>baliage</i> ; the painting of a lightener on clean, styled hair
haircoloring (HAYR-KUL-ur-ing)	p. 642	industry-coined term referring to artificial haircolor products and services; the addition of color on or into the hair shaft

hair lightening (HAYR LYT-un-ing)	p. 642	the chemical process of diffusing natural or artificial pigment from the hair
highlighting (HY-lyt-ing)	p. 663	coloring or lightening some strands of hair lighter than the natural color
hue (HYOO)	p. 646	the basic name of a color
laws of color	p. 644	a system for understanding color relationships
level (LEV-ul)	p. 646	unit of measurement to identify the lightness or darkness of a color
level system (LEV-ul SIS-tum)	p. 647	system used to analyze the lightness or darkness of a hair color or color product
lighteners (LYT-un-urz)	p. 656	chemical compounds that lighten hair by dispersing and diffusing natural pigment
line of demarcation (LYN UV dee-mar-KAY-shun)	p. 653	a visible line separating colored hair from new growth
lowlighting	p. 663	coloring some strands of hair darker than the natural hair color
off-the-scalp lighteners (AWF-THE-SKALP LYT-un-urz)	p. 658	lighteners that cannot be used directly on the scalp
on-the-scalp lighteners (AWN-THE-SKALP LYT-un-urz)	p. 657	lighteners that can be used directly on the scalp
patch test (PACH TEST)	p. 662	test for identifying a possible allergy to aniline derivative products; required by the FDA 24 to 48 hours before the application of the product
permanent haircolor (PUR-muh-nent HAYR-KUL-ur)	p. 652	lighten and deposit color at the same time and in a single process because they are more alkaline than no-lift, deposit-only colors and are usually mixed with a higher-volume developer
pre-lightening (pree-LYT-tin-ing)	p. 669	the first step of a double-process haircoloring; used to lighten natural pigment
pre-softening (pree-SOF-en-ing)	p. 663	process of treating resistant hair for better color penetration
primary colors (PRY-mayr-ee KUL-urz)	p. 645	red, blue, and yellow; colors that cannot be achieved from a mixture of other colors
progressive colors (pruh-GRES-iv KUL-urz)	p. 654	haircolor products that contain compound or metallic dyes, which build up on the hair; not used professionally
retouch application (ree-TUCH ap-lih-KAY-shun)	p. 662	application of the product to new growth only
secondary colors (SEK-un-deh-ree KUL-urz)	p. 645	colors obtained by mixing equal parts of two primary colors
semipermanent haircolor (sem-ee-PUR-muh-nent HAYR-KUL-ur)	p. 667	deposit-only haircolor product formulated to last through several shampoos
single-process haircoloring SING-gul-PRAH-ses HAYR-KUL-ur-ing	p. 662	process that lightens and colors the hair in a single application
soap cap (SOHP KAP)	p. 662	equal parts of tint and a shampoo
strand test (STRAND TEST)	p. 662	the application of a coloring or lightening product to determine how the hair will react to the formula and the amount of time it will take to process
temporary colors (TEM-poh-rayr-ee KUL-urz)	p. 650	color products that last only from shampoo to shampoo
tone (TOHN)	p. 646	term used to describe the warmth or coolness of a color.
toners (TOHN-urz)	p. 671	semipermanent, demipermanent, or permanent haircolor products used primarily on pre-lightened hair to achieve pale and delicate colors
virgin application (VUR-jin ap-lih-KAY-shun)	p. 662	the first time the hair is tinted or lightened
volume (VAHL-yoom)	p. 655	the measure of the potential oxidation of varying strengths of hydrogen peroxide

PART *5* BUSINESS SKILLS

19 PREPARING FOR
LICENSURE AND
EMPLOYMENT

20 WORKING BEHIND
THE CHAIR

21 THE BUSINESS OF
BARBERING





19



PREPARING FOR LICENSURE
AND EMPLOYMENT

CHAPTER OUTLINE

INTRODUCTION

WHY STUDY PREPARING FOR LICENSURE AND EMPLOYMENT?

PREPARE FOR LICENSURE

PREPARE FOR EMPLOYMENT

ARRANGE FOR A JOB INTERVIEW

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

LO¹

Describe the process of taking and passing your state licensing examinations.

LO²

Develop a resume and employment portfolio.

LO³

Know how to explore the job market, research potential employers, and operate within the legal aspects of employment.

Introduction

There are plenty of great jobs out there for energetic, hardworking, and talented people. If you look at the top professionals in the barbering field, you will find they were not born successful; they achieved success through self-motivation, energy, and persistence. Like you, these barbers began their careers by enrolling in barbering school, while others may have taken the apprenticeship route. In either case, they were the ones who used their time wisely, planned for the future, went the extra mile, and drew on a reservoir of self-confidence to meet challenges.

They owe their success to no one but themselves, because they created it. If you want to enjoy similar success, you must prepare for the opportunities that await you.

No matter what changes occur in the economy, there are often more jobs available for entry-level barbers than there are people to fill them. This is a tremendous advantage for you, but you must still thoroughly research the job market in your geographical area before committing to your first job (Figure 19-1). If you make the right choice, your career will be on the road to success. If you make the wrong choice, your career will not be a tragedy, but there will be unnecessary delay.

figure 19-1
Many barbering jobs are available.



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why study

PREPARING FOR LICENSURE AND EMPLOYMENT?

Barbers should study and have a thorough understanding of preparing for licensure and employment because:

- You must pass your state board exam to be licensed, and you must be licensed to be hired; therefore, preparing for licensure and passing your exam is your first step to employment success.
- A successful employment search is a job in itself, and there are many tools that can give you the edge—as well as mistakes that can cost you an interview or a job.
- The ability to pinpoint the right barbershop for you and target it as a potential employer is vital for your career success.
- Proactively preparing the right materials, such as a great resume, and practicing for interviewing give you the confidence that is needed to secure a job in a barbershop you love.

Prepare for Licensure

After reading this section, you will be able to:

- LO1** Describe the process of taking and passing your state licensing examinations.

Before you can obtain the career position you are hoping for, you must pass your state licensing examinations (usually a written and a practical exam) and secure the required credentials from your state's licensing board by filling out an application and paying a fee. For details on fees, testing dates, requirements, and more, visit the website of your state barber board or your state's department of licensing.

Many factors affect how well you perform during that licensing examination and on tests in general. They include your physical and psychological state; your memory; your time management skills; and your academic skills, such as reading, writing, note taking, test taking, and general learning.

Of all the factors that affect your test performance, the most important is your mastery of course content. However, even if you feel that you have truly learned the material, it is still very beneficial to have strong test-taking skills. Being **test-wise** (TEST-whys) means understanding the strategies for successfully taking tests.

PREPARING FOR THE WRITTEN EXAM

A test-wise student begins to prepare for a test by practicing good study habits and time management. These habits include the following:

- Have a planned, realistic study schedule (**Figure 19-2**).
- Read content carefully and become an active studier.
- Keep well-organized notes.
- Develop a detailed vocabulary list.
- Take effective notes during class.
- Organize and review handouts.
- Review past quizzes and tests.
- Listen carefully in class for cues and clues about what could be expected on the test.

More holistic hints to keep in mind include the following:

- Make yourself mentally ready and develop a positive attitude toward taking the test.
- Get plenty of rest the night before the test.
- Dress comfortably and professionally.
- Anticipate some anxiety (feeling concerned about the test results may actually help you do better).
- Avoid cramming the night before an examination.
- Find out if your state uses computers for the written portion of the test. If so, make certain you are comfortable with computerized test taking.

figure 19-2
Studying for your exam.





DID YOU KNOW?

If you have a physician-documented disability, such as a learning disability, your state may allow you extra time to take the written exam or even provide a special examiner. Ask your instructor and check with your state licensing board. Be certain to make any special arrangements well in advance of the test date.

ON TEST DAY

After you have taken all the necessary steps to prepare for your test, you can adopt a number of strategies on the day of the exam that may be helpful.

- Relax and try to slow down physically.
- Review the material lightly on the day of the exam.
- If possible, do a “test drive” to the site before test day if you are unsure of the location. Some exams may be administered at your school, and some may be given in alternate locations.
- Arrive early with a self-confident attitude; be alert, calm, and ready for the challenge.
- Read all written directions and listen carefully to all verbal directions before beginning.
- If there are things you do not understand, do not hesitate to ask the examiner questions.
- Scan the entire test before beginning.
- Budget your time to ensure that you have plenty of opportunity to complete the test; do not spend too much time on any one question.
- Wear a watch so that you can monitor the time.
- Begin work as soon as possible, and mark the answers in the test carefully but quickly.
- Answer the easiest questions first to save time for the more difficult ones. Quickly scanning all the questions first may clue you in to the more difficult questions.
- Make a note of the questions you skip so that you can find them again later. If the test is administered online, you may not be given this option. Some software prevents you from moving forward without first answering all the questions on the page. Discuss this with your instructor or the testing facility before taking the exam.
- Read each question carefully to make sure that you know exactly what the question is asking and that you understand all parts of the question.
- Answer as many questions as possible. For questions that cause uncertainty, guess or estimate.
- Look over the test when you are done to ensure that you have read all questions correctly and that you have answered as many as possible.
- Make changes to answers only if there is a good reason to do so.
- Check the test carefully before turning it in. (For instance, you might have forgotten to put your name on it!)

DEDUCTIVE REASONING

Deductive reasoning (DEE-duck-tiv REAS-on-ing) is the process of reaching logical conclusions by employing logical reasoning. *Deductive reasoning* is a technique that students should learn to use for better test results. Some strategies associated with deductive reasoning include the following:

- Eliminate options that are known to be incorrect. The more incorrect answers you can eliminate, the better your chances of identifying the correct answer.
- Watch for key words or terms. Look for any qualifying conditions or statements. Keep an eye out for phrases and words such as *usually*, *commonly*, *in most instances*, *never*, and *always*.
- Study the **stem** (STEM), which is the basic question or problem. It often provides a clue to the correct answer. Look for a match between the stem and one of the choices.
- Watch for grammatical clues. For instance, if the last word in a stem is *an*, the answer must begin with a vowel sound rather than a consonant.
- Look at similar or related questions. They may provide clues.
- When answering essay questions, watch for words such as *compare*, *contrast*, *discuss*, *evaluate*, *analyze*, *define*, or *describe*, and develop your answer accordingly.
- When questions include paragraphs to read and questions to answer, read the questions first. This helps you identify the important information as you read the paragraph.

UNDERSTANDING TEST FORMATS

There are a few additional tips that all test-wise learners should know, especially with respect to the state licensing examination. Keep in mind, of course, that the most important strategy of test taking is to know your material. Beyond that, consider the following tips on the various types of question formats.

True/False

Watch for qualifying words (*all*, *most*, *some*, *none*, *always*, *usually*, *sometimes*, *never*, *little*, *no*, *equal*, *less*, *good*, *bad*). Absolutes (*all*, *none*, *always*, *never*) are generally not true (Figure 19-3).

- For a statement to be true, the *entire* statement must be true.
- Long statements are more likely to be true than short statements. It takes more detail to provide truthful, factual information.

figure 19-3
True or false?

Multiple Choice

- Read the entire question carefully, including all the choices.
- Look for the best answer; more than one choice may be true.
- Eliminate incorrect answers by crossing them out (if taking the test on the test form).
- When two choices are close or similar, one of them is probably right.
- When two choices are identical, both must be wrong.
- When two choices are opposites, one is probably wrong and one is probably correct, depending on the number of other choices.



- “All of the above” and similar responses are often the correct choice.
- Pay special attention to words such as *not*, *except*, and *but*.
- Guess if you do not know the answer (provided that there is no penalty).
- The answer to one question may be in the stem of another.

Matching

- Read all items in each list before beginning.
- Check off items from the brief response list to eliminate choices.

Essays

- Organize your answer according to the cue words in the question.
- Think carefully and outline your answer before you begin writing.
- Make sure that what you write is complete, accurate, relevant to the question, well organized, and clear.

Remember that understanding test formats and effective test-taking strategies still does not take the place of having a complete understanding of the material on which you are being tested. To be successful at taking tests, you must follow the rules of effective studying and be thoroughly knowledgeable of the exam content for both the written and the practical examination.

BARBER LAW

In addition to testing basic theory concepts, the written exam often contains questions about your state’s barber laws and rules. The basic concept and functions of state barber boards remain the same: to protect the health, safety, and welfare of the public as it relates to the practice of barbering. However, when it comes to studying for your exam, it is important to be aware of the specific rules and regulations of your state. For example, there may be a test question that asks, “How many members of the barber board must be licensed barbers?” The answer to this question varies from state to state, so you need to know what the configuration of the barber board is in *your* state. Other questions relating to barber laws and regulations that may vary from state to state include, but are not limited to, the following:

- Chapter or administrative code number
- Number of board members
- Configuration of the board (barbers, public members, etc.)
- Terms of office
- Definitions
- Exemptions and exceptions
- Examination prerequisites (school hours, age, service requirements, etc.)
- Reexamination requirements
- Types of licenses
- License display

- License renewal dates
- Fees and penalties
- Minimum square footage for a barbershop
- Continuing education requirements
- Prohibited acts
- Qualifications for endorsement

Obtain copies of the barber board rules and regulations and candidate information literature for your state. Review these documents thoroughly and be guided by your instructor when preparing for written exams.

THE PRACTICAL EXAM

After completing the barber school curriculum, examination candidates should be competent in their technical skills and ready for state board **practical exams** (prac-ti-cal x-amz). Although performance criteria for practical examinations vary from state to state, the basic skills or procedures that are usually evaluated are haircutting, shaving, shampooing, infection control, and possibly blowdrying or a chemical service. A fairly standard testing protocol requires candidates to demonstrate competence with the comb, shears, razor, and clippers. Safety precautions, proper draping procedures, and the safe handling of tools are also important performance standards. Review barber board rules and candidate information literature for details about what you will be tested on at the practical exam.

Practical exam preparation requires a different approach than written exams. After all, performing services is what barbering is all about, and practical exams are the best way to evaluate a person's competency in barbering techniques and safety.

Basic preparation for practical exams should always include practice on the model that you will be taking to the examination. To feel confident about your performance, you must be familiar with the model's hair texture and the haircut that you will be performing. For example, many states require a taper haircut—knowing the characteristics of your model's hair and the best techniques for cutting it will help to eliminate some nervousness and stress during the practical exam.

To be better prepared for the practical portion of the examination, follow these tips:

- Practice the correct skills required for the test as often as you can.
- Participate in mock licensing examinations, complete with timed sections.
- Familiarize yourself with the content in the examination bulletin.
- Make a list of equipment and implements you are expected to bring to the examination.
- Make certain that all equipment and implements are clean and in good working order prior to the exam.
- If allowed by the regulatory or licensing agency, observe other practical examinations prior to taking yours.



DID YOU KNOW?

Although the extent of information made available to exam candidates varies from state to state, many states now maintain candidate information online for easy access, so be sure to review these valuable test-taking tools. In most cases, candidate information booklets or materials contain the following:

- Introduction to written and practical exams
- Examination rules
- Location and contact information for exams
- Manner of testing (computer-based, paper and pencil, etc.)
- Requirements, procedures, and reservation information for computer-based testing, if applicable
- Content overview—written (number of questions, subject areas, sample questions, etc.)
- Content overview—practical (specific procedures to be tested, possible points, etc.)
- Model requirements (practical)
- Tool and equipment requirements (practical)
- What to bring and what not to bring (written and practical)
- References used to write or develop the examinations
- Grading and scoring policies (reexamination information, notification of results, etc.)
- Administrative policies (late arrivals, cancellations, exam review process, etc.)

- As with any exam, listen carefully to the examiner's instructions, and follow them explicitly.
- Focus on your own knowledge and do not allow yourself to be concerned with what other test candidates are doing.
- Follow all infection control and safety procedures throughout the entire examination.
- Look the part. Every little bit helps; make certain your appearance is neat, clean, and professional.

Prepare for Employment

After reading this section, you will be able to:

LO2 Develop a resume and employment portfolio.

When you chose to enter the field of barbering, your primary goal was to find a good job after being licensed. Now you need to reaffirm that goal by reviewing a number of important questions.

- What do you really want out of a career in barbering?
- What particular areas within barbering are most interesting to you?
- What are your strongest practical skills? In what ways do you wish to use these skills?
- What personal qualities will help you have a successful career?

One way that you can answer these questions is to copy and complete the Inventory of Personal Characteristics and Technical Skills (Figure 19-4). After you have completed this inventory and identified the areas that need further attention, you can determine where to focus the remainder of your training. In addition, you should have a better idea of what type of establishment would best suit you for your eventual employment.

During your training, you may have the opportunity to network with various industry professionals who are invited to the school as guest speakers. Be prepared to ask them questions about what they like most and least in their current positions. Ask them for any tips they might have that will assist you in your search for the right barbershop. In addition, be sure to take advantage of your institution's in-house placement assistance program, if available, when you begin your employment search.

Your willingness to work hard is a key ingredient to your success. The commitment you make now in terms of time and effort will pay off later in the workplace, where your energy will be appreciated and rewarded. Having enthusiasm for getting the job done can be contagious, and when everyone works hard, everyone benefits. You can begin to develop this enthusiasm by establishing good work habits as a student.

figure 19-4

Inventory of personal characteristics and technical skills.

INVENTORY OF PERSONAL CHARACTERISTICS					
PERSONAL CHARACTERISTIC	Exc.	Good	Avg.	Poor	Plan for improvement
Posture, Deportment, Poise					
Grooming, Personal hygiene					
Manners, Courtesy					
Communication skills					
Attitude					
Self-motivation					
Personal habits					
Responsibility					
Self-esteem, Self-confidence					
Honesty, Integrity					
Dependability					

INVENTORY OF TECHNICAL SKILLS					
TECHNICAL SKILL	Exc.	Good	Avg.	Poor	Plan for improvement
Hair shaping/cutting					
Hairstyling					
Haircoloring					
Texture services, Perming					
Texture services, Relaxing					
Shaving					
Razor cutting					
Hair replacement					
Other					

After analyzing the above responses, would you hire yourself as an employee in your business? Why or why not?

State the short-term goals that you hope to accomplish in 6 to 12 months:

State the long-term goals that you hope to accomplish in 1 to 5 years:

Ask yourself: Do you want to work in a big city or small town? Would you feel more comfortable in a traditional barbershop or a trendy, upscale shop? Which clientele are you able to communicate with more effectively? Do you want to start out slowly and carefully, or do you want to jump in and throw everything into your career from the starting gate? Will you be in this industry throughout your working career, or is this just a stopover? Will you only work a 30- or 40-hour week, or will you go the extra mile when opportunities are available? How ambitious are you, and how many risks are you willing to take?

HOW TO GET THE JOB YOU WANT

There are several key personal characteristics that will not only help you get the position you want, but will also help you keep it. These characteristics include the following points:

- **Motivation.** This means having the drive to take the necessary action to achieve a goal. Although motivation can come from external sources—parental or peer pressure, for instance—the best kind of motivation is internal.
- **Integrity.** When you have integrity, you are committed to a strong code of moral and artistic values. Integrity is the compass that keeps you on course over the long haul of your career.
- **Good technical and communication skills.** While you may be better in either technical or communication skills, you must develop both to reach the level of success you desire.
- **Strong work ethic.** In the barbering business, having a strong **work ethic** (WOHRK ETH-ik) means taking pride in your work and committing yourself to consistently doing a good job for your clients, employer, and barbershop team.
- **Enthusiasm.** Try never to lose your eagerness to learn, grow, and expand your skills and knowledge.

ACTIVITY

For 1 week, keep a daily record of your performance in the following areas, and ask a few of your fellow students to provide feedback as well.

- Positive attitude
- Punctuality
- Diligent practice of newly learned techniques
- Teamwork
- Professional appearance
- Regular class and clinic attendance
- Interpersonal skills
- Helping others

WHERE TO WORK?

As you research employment opportunities, do not limit yourself to searching for barbershop positions alone. While the vast majority of barbers do work in barbershops, some perform services in either beauty or unisex salons—and increasing numbers find employment in hotels, resorts, and spas. Barbershops can vary significantly, not just in style, culture, and target market, but also in their organization. Many are small, independent shops in close contact with their owners and their personal tastes, while others are part of independent local chains or are regional franchise shops. All of these situations offer different opportunities that may or may not fit your needs and interests as a new barbering professional.

Another form of employment for barbers is renting a booth or chair, often within one of the locations mentioned earlier—indeed, almost half of all barbers and cosmetologists are booth renters. Booth renting is possibly the least expensive way of owning your own business, but this type of business is regulated by complex laws. The following two chapters will discuss booth rental in detail.

RESUME DEVELOPMENT

A **resume** (res-oo-MAY) is a written summary of a person's education and work experience. It tells potential employers at a glance what your achievements and accomplishments are. If you are a new graduate, you may have little or no work experience, in which case your resume should focus on skills and accomplishments. Here are some basic guidelines to follow when preparing your professional resume.

- Keep it simple; limit it to one page.
- Print a hard copy from your electronic version, using good-quality paper.
- Include your name, address, phone number, and e-mail address on both the resume and your cover letter.
- List recent, relevant work experience.
- List relevant education and the name of the institution from which you graduated, as well as relevant courses attended.
- List your professional skills and accomplishments.
- Focus on information that is relevant to the position you are seeking.

The average time that a potential employer will spend scanning your resume before deciding whether to grant you an interview is about 20 seconds. That means you must market yourself in such a manner that the reader will want to meet you. If your work experience has been in an unrelated field, show how the position helped you develop transferable skills. Restaurant work, for example, helps employees develop customer-service skills and learn to deal with a wide variety of clientele.

As you list former and current positions on your resume, focus on achievements instead of detailing duties and responsibilities. Accomplishment statements enlarge your basic duties and responsibilities. The best way to show concrete accomplishment is to include numbers or percentages, whenever possible. As you describe former and current positions on your resume, ask yourself the following questions:

- How many regular clients did I serve?
- How many clients did I serve weekly?
- What was my service ticket average?
- What was my client retention rate?
- What percentage of my client revenue came from retailing?
- What percentage of my client revenue came from color or texture services?

If you cannot express your accomplishment numerically, can you address which problems you solved or other results you achieved? For instance, did your office job help you develop excellent organizational skills?

This type of questioning can help you develop accomplishment statements that will interest a potential employer. There is no better time for you to achieve significant accomplishments than while you are in school. Even though your experience may be minimal, you must still present evidence of your skills and accomplishments. This may seem a difficult task at this early stage in your working career, but by closely examining your training and school clinic performance, extracurricular activities, and the full- or part-time jobs you have held, you should be able to create a good, attention-getting resume.

For example, consider the following questions:

- Did you receive any honors during your course of training?
- Were you ever selected “student of the month”?
- Did you receive special recognition for your attendance or academic progress?

- Did you win any barbering-related competitions while in school?
- What was your attendance average while in school?
- Did you work with the student body to organize any fundraisers? What were the results?

Answers to these types of questions may indicate your people skills, personal work habits, and personal commitment to success.

Since you have not yet completed your training, you have the opportunity to make some of the examples a reality before you graduate. Positive developments of this nature while you are still in school can do much to improve your resume.

The Dos and Don'ts of Resumes

You will save yourself from many problems and a lot of disappointment right from the beginning of your job search if you keep a clear idea in your mind of what to do and what not to do when it comes to creating a resume. Here are some of the dos:

- **Always put your complete contact information on your resume.** If your cell phone is your primary phone, list its number first, and add a landline if you have one.
- **Make your resume easy to read.** Use concise, clear sentences and avoid overwriting or flowery language.
- **Know your audience.** Use vocabulary and language that will be understood by your potential employer.
- **Keep your resume short.** One page is preferable.
- **Stress accomplishments.** Emphasize past accomplishments and the skills you used to achieve them.
- **Focus on career goals.** Highlight information that is relevant to your career goals and the position you are seeking.
- **Emphasize transferable skills.** The skills mastered at other jobs that can be put to use in a new position are **transferable skills** (TRANZ-fur-able SKILLZ).
- **Use action verbs.** Begin accomplishment statements with action verbs such as *achieved*, *coordinated*, *developed*, *increased*, *maintained*, and *strengthened*.
- **Make your resume neat.** A poorly structured, badly typed resume does not reflect well on you.
- **Include professional references.** Use only professional references on your resume, and make sure you give potential employers the person's title, place of employment, and telephone number.
- **Be realistic.** Remember that you are just starting out in a field that you hope will be a wonderful and fulfilling experience. Be realistic about what employers may offer to beginners.
- **Include a cover letter.** A cover letter is used to introduce yourself to the employer and to identify the position you are seeking.
- **Note any skills with new technologies.** Include software programs, web development tools, and computerized barbershop management systems.

Here are some of the don'ts for resume writing:

- **Avoid salary references.** Do not state your salary history.
- **Avoid information about why you left former positions.**
- **Do not stretch the truth.** Misinformation or untruthful statements usually catch up with you.

If you do not feel comfortable writing your own resume, consider seeking a professional resume writer or a job coach. There may be employment agencies that can help you as well; many online job search websites offer easy-to-use resume templates.

Review **Figure 19-5** that represents an achievement-oriented resume for a recent graduate of a barbering course. Remember that you are a total package, not just a resume. With determination, you will find the right position to begin your barbering career. Utilize all available resources during your resume development and job search process. For example, there is an abundance of best practice information available on the Internet, or you can communicate with an individual you may already know who has gone through the hiring process and can provide recommendations. Milady also has fantastic resources that can provide you with additional assistance when you begin your job search.



DID YOU KNOW?

Use your creativity and artistic abilities as a barber to create a resume that represents your style and sets you apart from the competition. Do a search for contemporary resumes on Pinterest, for instance, for ideas to get started on color options, new styles, and formatting to create a unique resume.

EMPLOYMENT PORTFOLIO

As you prepare to work in the field of barbering, an employment portfolio can be extremely useful. An **employment portfolio** (EM-ploy-ment PORT-fo-lee-oh) is a collection of photos and documents that reflect your skills, accomplishments, and abilities in your chosen career field. You may choose to have a printed or an online portfolio.

While the actual contents of the portfolio vary from graduate to graduate, there are certain items that have a place in any portfolio. A powerful online or printed portfolio includes the following elements:

- Diplomas, including high school and barbering school
- Awards and achievements received while being a barbering student
- Current resume, focusing on accomplishments
- Letters of reference from former employers
- Summary of continuing education and/or copies of training certificates
- Statement of membership in industry and other professional organizations
- Statement of relevant civic affiliations and/or community activities
- Before-and-after photographs of services that you have performed on clients or models
- Brief statement about why you have chosen a career in barbering
- Any other information that you regard as relevant

When you write the statement about why you chose a career in barbering, you might include the following elements:

- A statement that explains what you love about your new career
- A description about the importance of teamwork and how you see yourself as a contributing team member

figure 19-5

An achievement-oriented resume for a recent graduate of a barbering course.

John Styles

143 Fern Circle • Anytown, USA, 12345 • 123.555.1234 • Johnstyles@barberstyles.net • StyledToTheNines.blogspot.com

Objective

My objective is to obtain an apprentice position in an upscale barbershop focusing on straight razor shaving and education so I may become a seasoned hair designer.

Education

ABC Barbering Academy, Chicago, IL, May 2016

Oak Park River Forest High School, Oak Park, IL, May 2012

Overall GPA: 3.0

Clubs: Paint/Sketch Club, Theater Club, Yearbook Committee

Qualifications

- Creative, energetic, and devoted to the barbering industry
- Hold a current Illinois barber license and have a strong knowledge of trends
- Proven ability to retain clients and was booked solid with requests during my final 4 months of training
- Served as mentor to new students of the ABC Barbering Academy

Professional Experience

Creative

- Won Regional Barber Battle: Best Fade Design
- Developed an outstanding digital portfolio of photos showing cuts, color, and beards designs
- Received Award for Best Student Fade: IBS 2014

Sales and Client Retention

- Increased chemical services to 30 percent of my clinic volume by graduation
- Named *Student of the Month* for best attendance, best attitude, highest retail, and most services delivered
- Developed and retained a school-clinic client base of over 75 individuals, both male and female

Team Spirit

- Peer resource and mentor for new students' during their first 3 months of training
- Volunteered as the "go-to person" for other students to consult regarding formal hairstyles
- Created the official Academy Facebook page, where I regularly shared new industry information

Administration

- Supervised a student "shop team" that developed a business plan for opening a 12-chair, full-service barbershop. This project earned an "A" and was recognized for thoroughness, accuracy, and creativity
- Led the reorganization of the school dispensary, allowing for increased inventory control, and the streamlining of clinic operations
- Internet savvy with abilities in Microsoft Word, Excel, and PowerPoint

References

Please see the attached page for references.

- A description of methods and ideas you would use to increase service and retail revenue (Figure 19-6)

Once you have assembled your portfolio, ask yourself whether it accurately portrays you and your career skills. If it does not, identify what needs to be changed. If you are not sure, run it by a neutral party for feedback about how to make it more interesting and accurate. This kind of feedback is also useful when creating a resume. The portfolio, like the resume, should be prepared in a way that projects professionalism.

- For ease of use, you may want to separate sections of a printed portfolio with tabs.
- A bound portfolio should be easy to carry and show to potential employers and clients.
- If you are showing your online portfolio, be sure your electronic device is fully charged and the web page is bookmarked for easy retrieval.
- The photos should all have the same dimensions.

Online Portfolios

If you are technologically savvy or can hire someone to assist you, create a digital portfolio or an online showcase of your work. However, do not expect potential employers to take the extra time to visit a website or view a DVD. Bring along a printed copy of everything you want the employer to see.

Make it a habit to take photos of your work for your portfolio. Bring in models and practice the latest haircut, styling, or coloring techniques. Take compelling before-and-after photos to show your ability to transform your clients. For ideas, browse the Internet by doing a Google image search for *barbering portfolios*. Showcase your versatility by providing photos of various haircuts so your potential employer will gain a sense of your abilities.

There are many options you can use to create an online or electronic version of your portfolio. You can simply save your photos and scanned documents on a DVD, or you can easily create an online portfolio for free by utilizing a blog. Websites such as blogger.com or wordpress.com offer free blog sites that can easily serve as your online portfolio.

Do your homework, research carefully, and think long term. You, your portfolio, and web address want to be around for years to come. If creating a website is currently not in your budget, then create a “Fan Page” on Facebook to showcase your work. Remember: Your fan page is your business page and a representation of your professional image.

TARGETING THE ESTABLISHMENT

One of the most important steps in the process of job hunting is narrowing your search. Listed here are some points to keep in mind when targeting potential employers.

- Accept that your first job will probably not be your dream job. Few people are so fortunate.
- Do not wait until graduation to begin your search. If you do, you may be tempted to take the first offer you receive instead of carefully investigating all possibilities before making a decision.

figure 19-6

How will you increase retail revenue?



figure 19-7

What type of shop do you see yourself working in?



- Locate a barbershop that serves the type of clients you wish to serve. Finding a good fit with the clients and staff is critical from the outset of your career (**Figure 19-7**).
- Make a list of your area barbershops. The Internet will be your best source for this. If you are considering relocating to another area, go to anywho.com for a complete listing of businesses in every state, or find top barbershops in any region or city at citysearch.com. You may also want to do a Google search for your area of interest and city, using key words such as *barbershop Austin*.
- Watch for barbershops that advertise locally, to get a feel for the market each barbershop is targeting. Then check the barbershop's website or see if it is part of a social network, such as Facebook.
- Check out websites and social networking sites for various types of barbershops. If you contact them, do not waste their time. Get right to the point that you are a student, and ask specific questions about the profession.
- Keep the barbershop's culture in mind. Do the barbers dress like you? Are the clients in different age groups or just one? Look for the barbershop that will be best for you and your goals.

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FIELD RESEARCH

A great way to find out about potential jobs is to network. Actually get out there; visit barbershops; and talk to shop owners, managers, educators, and barbers. Whether your first contact is online, in person, or on the phone, sooner or later you will want to arrange a face-to-face meeting or an exploratory visit to the barbershop. To set up a shop visit, consider the following:

- If you call, use your best telephone manner; speak with confidence and self-assurance. If you e-mail, be brief, and check spelling and punctuation. Do not text message barbershop owners or managers, unless they request that you do so.
- Explain that you are preparing to graduate from school in barbering, that you are researching the market for potential positions, and that you have a few quick questions.
- If the person is receptive, ask whether the barbershop is in need of any new barbers, and how many the barbershop currently employs.
- Ask if you can make an appointment to visit the barbershop to observe sometime during the next few weeks. If the shop representative is agreeable, be on time! When timing allows, confirm the appointment the day before, via e-mail.

Remember that a rejection is not a negative reflection on you. Many professionals are too busy to make time for this kind of networking. The good news is that you are bound to discover many genuinely kind people who remember what it was like when they started out and who are willing to devote a bit of their time to help others who are beginning their careers.

WEB RESOURCES

To start looking for a barbering job, begin at these websites:

Industry specific:

- barber-license.com

General:

- careerbuilder.com
- resumeedge.com
- craigslist.org
- jobbank.com
- jobs.net
- monster.com
- snagajob.com

THE BARBERSHOP VISIT

When you visit the barbershop, take along a checklist to ensure that you observe all the key areas that might ultimately affect your decision making. The checklist will be similar to the one used for field trips that you probably have taken to area barbershops while in school. Keep the checklist on file for future reference so that you can make informed comparisons among establishments (Figure 19-8).

After your visit, always remember to follow up with a handwritten note or e-mail, thanking the barbershop representative for his time (Figure 19-10). Do this even if you did not like the barbershop and would never consider working there (Figure 19-10).

Never burn your bridges. Instead, build a network of contacts who have a favorable opinion of you.

figure 19-8
Barbershop visit checklist.

BARBERSHOP VISIT CHECKLIST	
When you visit a barbershop, observe the following areas and rate them from 1 to 5, with 5 considered being the best.	
_____	BARBERSHOP IMAGE: Is the barbershop's image consistent and appropriate for your interests? Is the image pleasing and inviting? What is the decor and arrangement? If you are not comfortable or if you find it unattractive, mark the barbershop off your list of employment possibilities.
_____	PROFESSIONALISM: Do the employees present the appropriate professional appearance and behavior? Do they give their clients the appropriate levels of attention and personal service, or do they act as if work is their time to socialize?
_____	MANAGEMENT: Does the barbershop show signs of being well managed? Is the phone answered promptly with professional telephone skills? Is the mood of the barbershop positive? Does everyone appear to work as a team?
_____	CLIENT SERVICE: Are clients greeted promptly and warmly when they enter the barbershop? Are they kept informed of the status of their appointment? Are they offered a magazine or beverage while they wait? Is there a comfortable reception area?
_____	PRICES: Compare price for value. Are clients getting their money's worth? Do they pay the same price in one barbershop but get better service and attention in another? If possible, take home barbershop brochures and price lists.
_____	RETAIL: Is there a well-stocked retail display offering clients a variety of product lines and a range of prices? Do the barbers and receptionist (if applicable) promote retail sales?
_____	IN-SHOP MARKETING: Are there posters or promotions throughout the barbershop? If so, are they professionally made, and do they reflect contemporary styles?
_____	SERVICES: Make a list of all services offered by each barbershop and the product lines they carry. This will help you decide what earning potential the barbers have in each barbershop.
BARBERSHOP NAME: _____	
BARBERSHOP MANAGER: _____	

figure 19-9
Sample thank-you note.

Dear Ms. (or Mr.) _____,

I appreciate having had the opportunity to observe your barbershop in operation last Friday. Thank you for the time you and your staff gave me. I was impressed by the efficient and courteous manner in which your barbers served their clients. The atmosphere was pleasant, and the mood was positive. Should you ever have an opening for a professional with my skills and training, I would welcome the opportunity to apply. You can contact me at the e-mail address and phone number listed below. I hope we will meet again soon.

Sincerely,
(your name, address, telephone, e-mail address)

figure 19-10
Sample thank-you note to a barbershop where you do not expect to seek employment.

Dear Ms. (or Mr.) _____,

I appreciate having had the opportunity to observe your barbershop in operation last Friday. I know how busy you and all your staff are, and I want to thank you for the time that you gave me. I hope my presence didn't interfere with the flow of your operations too much. I certainly appreciate the courtesies that were extended to me by you and your staff. I wish you and your barbershop continued success.

Sincerely,
(your name)

Arrange for a Job Interview

After reading this section, you will be able to:

- LO 3** Know how to explore the job market, research potential employers, and operate within the legal aspects of employment.

After you have graduated and completed the first two steps in the process of securing employment—targeting and observing barbershops—you are ready to pursue employment in earnest. The next step is to contact the establishments that you are most interested in by sending them a resume and requesting an interview. Choosing a barbershop that is the best match to your skills will increase your chances of success.

figure 19-11
Sample cover letter.

Your Name
Your Address
Your Phone Number

Ms. (or Mr.) _____
Barbershop Name
Barbershop Address

Dear Ms. (or Mr.) _____,

We met in August when you allowed me to observe your barbershop and staff while I was still in training. Since that time, I have graduated and have received my license. I have enclosed my resume for your review and consideration.

I would appreciate the opportunity to meet with you and discuss either current or future career opportunities at your barbershop. I was extremely impressed with your staff and business, and I would like to share with you how my skills and training might add to your barbershop success.

I look forward to meeting with you again soon.

Sincerely,
(your name)

Many barbershops have websites with special employment areas; others post position openings on barbering- or job-related websites. Follow instructions exactly for filling out forms or sending resumes (some barbershops do not want attachments, such as letters of recommendation or digital portfolios sent with the resumes). In rare instances, you may need to send a resume and cover letter by traditional snail mail (**Figure 19-11**). Comply with the barbershop's guidelines.

Mark your calendar to remind yourself to make a follow-up contact. A week after submitting your resume is generally sufficient. When you call or e-mail, try to schedule an interview appointment. Keep in mind that some barbershops may not have openings and may not be granting interviews. When this is the case, send a resume, if you have not already, and ask the barbershop to keep it on file should an opening arise in the future. Be sure to thank your contacts for their time and consideration.

INTERVIEW PREPARATION

When preparing for an interview, make sure that you have all the necessary information and materials in place, including the following items.

Identification

- Social Security number
- Driver's license number

- Names, mailing addresses, e-mail addresses, and phone numbers of former employers
- Name, phone number, and e-mail address of the nearest relative not living with you

Interview Wardrobe

Your appearance is crucial, especially since you are applying for a position in the barbering industry. It is recommended that you obtain one or two interview outfits. You may be requested to return for a second interview, hence the need for the second outfit. Consider the following points:

- Is the outfit appropriate for the position?
- Is it both fashionable and flattering, and similar to what the barber-shop's current barbers wear? (If you have not visited the barbershop, walk by or check out its website to gauge its style culture so that you can dress accordingly.)
- Are your accessories both fashionable and functional (e.g., not noisy or so large that they would interfere with performing services)?
- Are your nails well groomed?
- Is your hairstyle current? Does it flatter your face and your overall style?
- Is your makeup current? Does it flatter your face and your overall style?
- Are you clean shaven? If not, is your beard properly trimmed?
- Is your perfume or cologne subtle (or nonexistent)?
- Are you carrying either a handbag or a briefcase, but not both?



HERE'S A TIP

When you contact a barbershop to make an appointment for an interview, you may be told that they are not currently hiring but would be happy to conduct an interview for future reference. Never think that this would be a waste of time.

Take advantage of the opportunity. Not only will it give you valuable interview experience, but it may also provide opportunities that you would otherwise miss.

Supporting Materials

- **Resume.** Even if you have already sent a resume, take another copy with you.
- **Facts and figures.** Have ready a list of names and dates of former employment, education, and references.
- **Employment portfolio.** Even if you have just two photos in your portfolio and they are pictures of haircuts you did for friends, bring them along.

Review and Prepare for Anticipated Interview Questions

Certain questions are typically asked during an interview. Being familiar with these questions allows you to reflect on your answers ahead of time. You might even consider role-playing an interview situation with friends, family, or fellow students. Typical questions include the following:

- Why do you want to work here?
- What did you like best about your training?
- Are you punctual and regular in attendance?
- Will your school director or instructor confirm this?
- What skills do you feel are your strongest?

- In which areas do you consider yourself to be less strong?
- Are you a team player? Please explain.
- Do you consider yourself flexible? Please explain.
- What are your career goals?
- What days and hours are you available for work?
- Are there any obstacles that would prevent you from keeping your commitment to full-time employment? Please explain.
- What assets do you believe that you would bring to this barbershop and this position?
- What computer skills do you have?
- How would you handle a problem client?
- How do you feel about retailing?
- Would you be willing to attend our company's training program?
- Would you please describe ways that you provide excellent customer service?
- What consultation questions might you ask a client?
- Are you prepared to train for a year before you have your own clients?



DID YOU KNOW?

It can be difficult for new graduates to afford the two or three outfits necessary to project a confident and professional image when going out into the workplace. Fortunately, several nonprofit organizations have been formed to address this need. These organizations receive donations of clean clothes in good repair from individuals and manufacturers. The items are then passed along to people who need them. For more information, visit Wardrobe for Opportunity at wardrobe.org and Dress for Success at dressforsuccess.org.

Be Prepared to Perform a Service

Some barbershops require applicants to perform a service in their chosen discipline as part of the interview, and many of these barbershops require that you bring your own model. Be sure to confirm whether this is a requirement. If it is, make sure that your model is appropriately dressed and properly prepared for the experience and that you bring the necessary supplies, products, and tools to demonstrate your skills.

THE INTERVIEW

On the day of the interview, try to make sure that nothing occurs that will keep you from completing the interview successfully. You should practice the following behaviors in connection with the interview itself.

- Always be on time or, better yet, early. If you are unsure of the location, find it the day before, so there will be no reason for delays.
- Turn off your cell phone! Do not arrive with earbuds or a hands-free cell phone device in your ear.
- Project a warm, friendly smile. Smiling is the universal language.
- Walk, sit, and stand with good posture.
- Be polite and courteous.
- Do not sit until you are asked to do so or until it is obvious that you are expected to do so.
- Never smoke or chew gum, even if one or the other is offered to you.
- Do not come to an interview with a cup of coffee, a soft drink, snacks, or anything else to eat or drink.



ACTIVITY

Find a partner among your fellow students and role-play the employment interview. Each of you can take turns as the applicant and the employer. After each session, conduct a brief discussion regarding how it went; that is, what worked and what did not work. Discuss how your performance could be improved. Bear in mind that a role-playing activity will never predict exactly what will occur in a real interview. However, the process will help prepare you for the interview and boost your confidence.

- Never lean on or touch the interviewer's desk. Some people do not like their personal space broached without an invitation.
- Try to project a positive first impression by appearing as confident and relaxed as you can be.
- Speak clearly. The interviewer must be able to hear and understand you.
- Answer questions honestly. Think about the question and answer carefully. Do not speak before you are ready, and not for more than 2 minutes at a time.
- Never criticize former employers.
- Always remember to thank the interviewer at the end of the interview.

Another critical part of the interview comes when you are invited to ask the interviewer questions of your own. You should think about those questions ahead of time and bring a list if necessary. Doing so will show that you are organized and prepared. Some questions that you might consider include the following:

- What are you looking for in a barber?
- Is there a job description? May I review it?
- Is there a shop manual? May I review it?
- How does the barbershop promote itself?
- How long do barbers typically work here?
- Are employees encouraged to grow in skills and responsibility? How so?
- Does the barbershop offer continuing education opportunities?
- What does your training program involve?
- Is there room for advancement? If so, what are the requirements for promotion?
- What key benefits does the barbershop offer, such as advanced training and medical insurance?
- What outside and community activities is the barbershop involved in?
- What is the form of compensation?
- When will the position be filled?
- May I contact you in a week regarding your decision?
- May I have a tour of the barbershop?

Do not feel that you have to ask all of your questions. The point is to create as much of a dialogue as possible. Be aware of the interviewer's reactions and make note of when you have asked enough questions. By obtaining the answers to at least some of your questions, you can compare the information you have gathered about other barbershops and choose the one that offers the best package of income and career development.

Remember to follow up the interview with a thank-you note or e-mail. It should simply thank the interviewer for the time she spent with you.

Close with a positive statement that you want the job (if you do). If the interviewer's decision comes down to two or three possibilities, the one expressing the most desire may be offered the position. Also, if the interviewer suggests that you call to learn about the employment decision, then by all means do so.

LEGAL ASPECTS OF THE EMPLOYMENT INTERVIEW

Over the years, a number of legal issues have arisen about questions that may or may not be included in an employment application or interview, including ones that involve race/ethnicity, religion, and national origin; marital status; sexual orientation; and if you have children. Generally, there should be no questions in any of these categories. Additional categories of appropriate and inappropriate questions are listed here.

- **Age or date of birth.** It is permissible to ask the age if the applicant is younger than 18. Otherwise, age should not be relevant in most hiring decisions; therefore, date-of-birth questions prior to employment are improper.
- **Disabilities or physical traits.** The Americans with Disabilities Act prohibits general inquiries about health problems, disabilities, and medical conditions.
- **Drug use or smoking.** Questions regarding drug or tobacco use are permitted. In fact, the employer may obtain the applicant's agreement to be bound by the employer's drug and smoking policies and to submit to drug testing.
- **Citizenship.** Employers are not allowed to discriminate because an applicant is not a U.S. citizen. However, employers can request to see a Green Card or work permit.

It is important to recognize that not all potential employers understand that they may be asking improper or illegal questions. If you are asked such questions, you might politely respond that you believe the question is irrelevant to the position you are seeking and that you would like to focus on your qualities and skills that are suited to the job and the mission of the establishment.

EMPLOYEE CONTRACTS

Employers can legally require you to sign contracts as a condition of employment. In the barbering business, the most common ones are non-compete and confidentiality agreements. Barbershop owners often invest a great deal in training, and they do not want you taking all that education to a competing barbershop across the street once your apprenticeship or initial training is complete. Noncompete agreements address this issue, prohibiting you from seeking employment within a given time period and



DID YOU KNOW?

These are examples of illegal questions as compared to legal questions.

Illegal Questions

- How old are you?
- Please describe your medical history.
- Are you a U.S. citizen?
- What is your native language?

Legal Questions

- Are you over the age of 18?
- Are you physically able to perform this job?
- Are you authorized to work in the United States?
- In which languages are you fluent?

geographic area after you leave employment with them. Often, noncompete agreements also forbid employees from gathering and keeping client records, including client phone numbers. A contract cannot interfere with your right to work, and as a result, these contracts must be very specific and are sometimes controversial. If you are presented with any contract, take it home, read it, and make certain you completely understand it. If you do not completely understand any part of it, consult with a labor-law attorney before signing it.

THE EMPLOYMENT APPLICATION

Any time that you are applying for any position, you will be required to complete an application, even if your resume already contains much of the requested information. Your resume and the list you have prepared prior to the interview will assist you in completing the application quickly and accurately.

DOING IT RIGHT

You are ready to set out on your exciting new career as a professional barber. The right way to proceed is by learning important study and test-taking skills early and applying them consistently.

Think ahead to your employment opportunities and use your time in school to develop a record of interesting, noteworthy activities that will make your resume more exciting. When you compile a history that shows how you have achieved your goals, your confidence will grow.

- Always take one step at a time. Be sure to take the helpful preliminary steps that we have discussed when preparing for employment.
- Develop a dynamic portfolio. Keep your materials, information, and questions organized to ensure a high-impact interview.

Once you are employed, take the necessary steps to learn all that you can about your new position and the establishment you will be serving. Read all you can about the industry. Attend trade shows and take advantage of as much continuing education as you can manage. Become an active participant in efforts to make the barbering industry even better.

As you transition into your new career as a barbering professional, let us at Milady continue the journey with you. Be sure to visit the MiladyPro.com website. In addition to helping you prepare for your State Board Exam, MiladyPro.com offers access to materials designed to help you hit the ground running and grow your skill set, assuring long-term success no matter where you may take your career.